VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

CSE0001 – DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

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Introduction

This report documents my Digital Literacy Portfolio, submitted as part of the CSE0001 course at VIT Bhopal University. As a first-year student selected as a Student Digital Ambassador, I was tasked with building a comprehensive portfolio that demonstrates digital awareness, professional online presence, coding platform familiarity, effective communication skills, and cybercrime awareness.

The project is divided into five tasks, each mapping to a module of the course. All deliverables are organised in a single GitHub repository. This report summarises what I did in each task, the tools I used, my reflections, and the key lessons I gained. The goal of this project is not merely academic — the skills developed here are directly applicable to professional and academic life as a computer science student in the digital age.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic

Overview

For this task, I created a one-page digital infographic to help my batchmates understand the concept of digital literacy and why it matters for students today.

Tool Used

I used Canva (canva.com) — a free, browser-based graphic design tool that requires no installation. Canva's drag-and-drop interface made it easy to create a visually appealing, professional infographic without any prior design experience.

Design Description

The infographic is titled 'Be Digitally Literate – Your Guide to the Online World' and is designed in a clean blue-and-white colour scheme. It covers the following four topics arranged in a 2x2 grid layout:

- What is Digital Literacy? – A concise definition and its importance for students, professionals, and citizens.
- Useful Digital Tools for Students – Google Workspace, GitHub, Canva, and productivity apps like Notion.
- Safe Internet Practices – Strong passwords, two-factor authentication, avoiding phishing links, keeping software updated.

Reflection

Creating this infographic was one of the most engaging parts of the project. I had never used Canva before, and I was genuinely surprised by how intuitive it is. The most challenging aspect was the layout — ensuring all four sections had equal visual weight without any one topic dominating the design. I had to resize icons and adjust font sizes multiple times before the poster felt balanced.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

Overview

In this task, I set up my foundational professional digital presence by creating and updating profiles on three key platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

Platforms Set Up

GitHub

GitHub is the world's leading version control and code hosting platform. I created an account and set up a Profile README — a special repository named after my username — containing my name, branch, year, and a brief statement about what I hope to learn during my Integrated M.Tech programme.

LinkedIn

LinkedIn is the world's largest professional networking platform. I created a profile and filled in the Education section with my current degree (Integrated M.Tech CSE), institution (VIT Bhopal University), and expected graduation year (2030). All details were kept professional and minimal as instructed.

Kaggle

Kaggle is an online platform for data science and machine learning, widely used by students and professionals for practice datasets, competitions, and learning. I created an account and explored the beginner learning resources available in Python and data science.

Reflection

Setting up these three profiles was more meaningful than I initially expected. I now understand that your digital presence is essentially your professional identity — it is what employers, internship coordinators, and collaborators see before they ever meet you. Starting early, even with a minimal profile, is far better than having no presence at all.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Overview

This task had two parts: gaining familiarity with a coding practice platform (HackerRank), and building a collaborative tool using Google Workspace (Google Forms).

Part A – HackerRank

I created an account on HackerRank and completed two introductory challenges in the Python domain: 'Solve Me First' (compute the sum of two integers) and 'Say Hello World with Python'. Both challenges passed all test cases. Although simple, these exercises introduced me to how online judges work — the concept of test case evaluation and automated scoring that is central to competitive programming and technical interviews.

Part B – Google Forms (Digital Literacy Quiz)

I created a Google Form titled 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz – VIT Bhopal' with exactly 5 questions: three multiple-choice questions (covering the definition of digital literacy, safe password practices, and phishing awareness) two short question answer.The form was linked to a Google Sheet to automatically capture and display responses.

Reflection

These two tools represent two entirely different but equally important aspects of a CSE student's digital toolkit. HackerRank taught me the mechanics of competitive coding — and more importantly, it showed me that I am capable of writing and submitting code successfully, which was a confidence boost as a first-year student. Google Forms taught me the power of cloud collaboration: a form can be shared with hundreds of people, and the responses are automatically collected and analysed in real time.

Academically, Google Workspace will be indispensable throughout my degree — for group projects, surveys, presentations, and documentation.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette & Communication Guide

Overview

This task focused on professional written communication — specifically, how to write well-structured, appropriately toned emails in academic and professional contexts, and how to behave responsibly on social media.

Email 1 – Assignment Extension Request

I drafted an email from a student to a professor requesting a two-day extension on an assignment deadline. The email includes a clear subject line with the course code and student name, a respectful and professional salutation, a specific reason for the request, an assurance of work already completed, an apology for inconvenience, and a polite sign-off.

Email 2 – Internship Expression of Interest

I drafted an email to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship. This email highlights the student's current academic stage, proactive skills built (HackerRank, GitHub, Python exploration), the value of the internship to the student, and a call to action. It ends with a professional signature including GitHub and LinkedIn links.

Social Media Checklist

I also created a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist with 7 Do's (keeping profiles professional, using privacy settings, verifying before sharing, etc.) and 6 Don'ts (not sharing passwords, avoiding cyberbullying, not posting in anger, etc.). The checklist is saved separately as social-media-checklist.md.

Reflection – Digital Communication Scenario

One real-world example that illustrates the consequences of poor digital communication: In 2018, a senior executive at a large company in India posted a politically charged opinion on LinkedIn.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

Overview

For this task, I researched UPI/Online Payment Fraud — one of the most prevalent forms of cybercrime targeting college students in India today — and produced a case study and a prevention checklist.

Case Study Summary: The 'Request Money' UPI Scam

In this realistic scenario, a student selling a bicycle on an online marketplace receives a call from a fraudster posing as a buyer. The fraudster sends a UPI Collect Request (which requires the recipient to enter their PIN to approve it) instead of initiating a payment. The student, unfamiliar with how UPI Collect Requests work, approves the request by entering their PIN — believing they are receiving money — and instantly loses Rs. 5,000.

The core deception exploits a critical misunderstanding: on all UPI apps, entering your PIN always authorises an outgoing payment. You never need to enter your PIN to receive money. Once this rule is understood, the scam becomes immediately obvious — but for first-time UPI users, the confusion is genuinely easy to fall into. The full case study (200+ words) is available in task-5-cybercrime/casestudy.md in the repository.

Prevention Checklist Summary

The prevention checklist contains 15 actionable tips across three categories: general digital safety (strong passwords, 2FA, software updates, avoiding unknown links), UPI and financial safety (two dedicated tips: never enter your PIN to 'receive' money, and never share UPI PIN/OTP/CVV), and awareness and behaviour (verifying sellers, avoiding unknown apps, being careful on public Wi-Fi). It also includes the two official Indian reporting channels: cybercrime.gov.in and the 1930 helpline.

Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was how widespread UPI fraud is — and how sophisticated some of these scams have become. I had assumed that most cybercrime victims were elderly or less educated users. In reality, many victims are young, educated people — including engineering students — who simply do not know the specific technical rule that entering a UPI PIN always means sending money, never receiving it.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this task: I will always double-check whether a UPI notification is a 'payment' or a 'collect request' before entering my PIN. I will also never accept a collect request from someone I am selling something to — a legitimate buyer sends money directly; they do not ask me to approve anything.

Conclusion

This project has been one of the most practically valuable academic exercises I have undertaken so far. Unlike traditional assignments that test textbook knowledge, this project required me to actually do things in the real digital world: create accounts, design visuals, write professional communication, and research real-world threats.

The five tasks together paint a comprehensive picture of what it means to be digitally literate in 2025: you must be able to present yourself professionally online (Task 2), communicate effectively in writing (Task 4), use the right tools for the right purposes (Tasks 1 and 3), and protect yourself and your peers from digital threats (Task 5). None of these skills were things I had formally learned before — and yet all of them are expected of me as a professional engineer. This project helped bridge that gap.

My GitHub repository will remain a permanent part of my digital portfolio — and that, more than any mark, is the real deliverable of this course.

References

- Canva – Free Online Design Tool: https://canva.com
- GitHub – Code Hosting Platform: https://github.com
- LinkedIn – Professional Networking: https://linkedin.com
- Kaggle – Data Science Platform: https://kaggle.com
- HackerRank – Coding Practice Platform: https://hackerrank.com
- Google Forms – Survey & Quiz Tool: https://forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal (India): https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline: 1930 (24x7 toll-free, India)
- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) – UPI Fraud Awareness: https://npci.org.in
- SlidesCarniVal – Free PPT/Google Slides Templates: https://slidescarnival.com